



Import data from spreadsheets and databases

At this point, you've learned all

about internal and external data, and how to prepare it for use. Now, we'll go through the process

of actually importing data from different sources. Sometimes you want to upload a spreadsheet from your files, such as a CSV file. CSV stands for comma-separated values. A CSV file saves data in a table format. Now, let's bring that file

into a fresh spreadsheet. We'll start by selecting a file,

then import. Then we'll choose to upload a file. Navigate to it, open it and

insert it as a new sheet. CSV files use plain text and

they're delineated by characters. So each column or field is clearly

distinct from another when importing. As you learned, CSVs

are comma-separated, and usually the spreadsheet app will

auto-detect those separations. But sometimes, you might need to indicate

that the separator is another character or a space by selecting the different

options in this window. Also, if you are planning

to work with the data set, you would usually convert to text,

numbers or other options here. But plain text is okay for

reporting purposes. So we can leave those fields alone. Finally, select Import data. Now our

CSV file's ready to

work with in our spreadsheet. I spend most of my time at work analyzing

spreadsheets full of healthcare information. I typically start by looking at a larger data set. Then I pull a subset of it into a spreadsheet so I can work with it. Maybe I want to analyze year over year growth in user demand on Google Search for certain healthcare services, like telemedicine. Or maybe I want to look at data sets from external healthcare organizations or agencies for more insight into this trend. For example, with telemedicine, maybe I'll look at a spreadsheet that lists telemedicine providers. There are so many ways spreadsheets can help you find the insights you need. One source I use a lot is the World Health Organization's data repository. This is a place where anybody can access open-source data. As you can see, there's tons of data available. You can search by theme, category, indicator and country. You can also access World Health Organization metadata if you want to learn more about the data in the repository. For our example, we'll look at medical doctors by country and year. This information would be useful for a data analysis project looking into how many doctors are available to treat patients within a certain population compared to other populations. To get this data, we'll start on this webpage, which contains the data set we want. Then we'll download the data as a CSV file. Then open a new spreadsheet and import the file by selecting File, Import. Next, upload your file and select Import Data. After reviewing the data to make sure it looks clean, we can title it and begin our work. I know this is a lot of information to take in, but you'll get much more comfortable

with this the more you practice. Coming up, we'll learn how to sort and filter your data to focus on the information relevant to you.